

Figure 7: A directory with text files that have different filename conventions

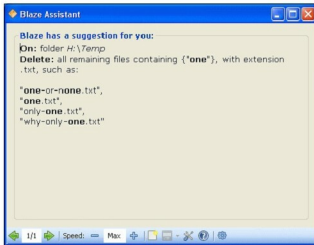


Figure 8: Blaze Assistant has detected the pattern

Another place in which such a feature will be useful is the file rename. Most of the handycams or mobile cameras have a convention of having filenames with a prefix. It could be 'DSC00001.jpg', 'DSC0002.jpg' and so on. Of the thousands of pictures, you may want to rename the first 50 as 'Manali vacation 001.jpg' to 'Manali vacation 050.jpg'. This is a very simple task with Blaze. You do the rename operation for the first three files and Blaze will detect the pattern for you.

Music tag indexing

Blaze comes with a plugin (bundled along with the default installation) that does music folder indexing, not just based on filenames but also on the MP3 tags. This means that if the MP3 files stored on your computer have tags embedded, you can search for music based on your favourite music director, singer or even actor.

Insert quick text

You can use this smart utility to save commonly e-mailed



Figure 9: Adding new Quick Text

or typed text—for example, if you frequently have to e-mail your home or office address to your friends or partners. If you are a programmer, there is a standard header or footer that you want to insert in the new files you create. This utility is also helpful if you just want to store a 16-character alphanumeric special character password. In all these situations, you just need to type or copy existing text to a clipboard. Invoke Blaze and type *Add New Quick Text*. You will then be prompted with a small form to enter a name for the text that you just copied. For example, if it is your 'shipping address', you can type *courier* against that address.

To use the stored text in any application like an editor, e-mail, or password prompt, you should invoke Blaze and type *insert <name>*, where 'name' is what you stored text against. To insert the address we just copied, type *insert courier*.

By now you must have understood why Blaze stands apart when it comes to features and the level of application integration. If you are still not convinced, you can read the excellent dissertation in the References section, which compares Blaze with 25 other similar competing utilities. I thank the developer and maintainer, Gabriel Barata, for such a powerful utility. 

References

- [1] Blaze vs rest of the world - An excellent dissertation for a masters' degree which compares Blaze and 25 other similar products. <https://dSPACE.ist.utl.pt/bitstream/2295/570168/1/dissertation%2520v2.pdf>
- [2] Blaze Homepage - to download and get started - <http://blaze-wins.sourceforge.net/>

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